

VETERAN RETREAT PROGRAM

TURNING THE TIDES

Healing combat veterans through land, sea, and community.

MAUI, HAWAII • A 501(c)(3) IN FORMATION

THE PROBLEM

A Generation Bringing the War Home.

Combat veterans return to civilian life carrying invisible wounds. Conventional treatment helps some — but for many, clinical settings, long wait times, and isolation from people who understand keep them stuck.

20%

OF POST-9/11
VETERANS
EXPERIENCE PTSD

17

VETERAN SUICIDES
PER DAY IN THE U.S.

**30+
days**

AVERAGE VA MENTAL
HEALTH WAIT TIMES

2-4×

HIGHER PTSD RISK
FOR COMBAT
VETERANS

An Immersive Retreat That Actually Works.

Combat veterans come to Maui for 7-14 days. They work the land, surf the ocean, connect with other veterans, and reset. Always free. Built by a combat veteran, for combat veterans.

THREE PILLARS — ALL EVIDENCE-BACKED



Farm & Land Work

Agri-therapy with local Maui farmers. Plant, harvest, build. Restore daily routine and purpose.



Outdoor & Ocean

Surfing, paddling, hiking, snorkeling. Quiet the nervous system. Reconnect with the body.



Community

Small cohorts of 4-8 veterans. Peer-led. Real bonds with people who understand.

FOUNDER'S STORY

I Built This Because It Saved Me.

"I served two combat tours in Iraq. What helped me come home wasn't a clinic — it was other veterans, real work, and time on the land. I want every combat veteran to have that."

John Collins — Founder, Turning the Tides

U.S. Army Infantry | Two combat tours, Baghdad (2008, 2010)

LOCATION

Why Maui?

Our retreat is set on private farmland in Maui. The combination of warm climate, ocean access, working farmland, and the genuine warmth of the local community creates a healing environment that nowhere else on earth can match.

- **Year-round growing season** — meaningful farm work in any month
- **Iconic ocean access** — Ho'okipa, Kihei, Molokini, Honolua Bay
- **Haleakalā & sacred lands** — natural environments that ground people fast
- **Aloha spirit** — local community brings veterans into something larger than themselves
- **Far from triggering daily contexts** — true reset

EVIDENCE BASE

Evidence-Backed. Lived-Experience Built.

- **Horticultural therapy** — peer-reviewed studies show reductions in PTSD symptoms, cortisol levels, and depression scores
- **Surf therapy** — researched at scale by the Department of Defense for veteran PTSD; consistent positive outcomes
- **Peer support** — among the strongest predictors of long-term recovery from combat PTSD
- **Nature-based interventions** — proven to reduce hyperarousal and improve sleep quality
- **What's missing in conventional care:** someone who's been there, an environment that's not clinical, and time

PROGRAM OVERVIEW

The Retreat Experience

7-14

DAYS PER RETREAT

4-8

VETERANS PER COHORT

\$0

COST TO VETERANS (ALWAYS)

100%

COMBAT VETERANS ONLY (PRIORITY)

Mornings on the farm. Afternoons in the ocean or on the trails. Evenings together — shared meals from food they grew, fire circles when veterans want to share, real rest when they don't.

BUSINESS MODEL

How We Sustain It.

Turning the Tides operates as a 501(c)(3) nonprofit. Veteran retreats are free, funded by a diversified mix:

Foundation Grants	~45%
Individual Donations	~20%
Corporate Sponsorships	~15%
Paid Civilian Wellness Retreats	~15%
Government & Specialty Grants	~5%

Civilian wellness retreats use the same land between veteran retreats — paying participants directly fund free veteran spots.

FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS

3-Year Outlook

YEAR 1 (PILOT)**3 retreats**

15-18 veterans served

\$65k budget

(founder serves unpaid)

YEAR 2 (BUILD)**5 retreats**

30 veterans served

\$200k budget**YEAR 3 (SCALE)****8 retreats**

48 veterans served

\$300k budget

Cost per veteran: ~\$4,300 (Year 1). For comparison, the VA spends an average of \$11,000 per year on a single PTSD-diagnosed veteran's outpatient care. The founder serves as an unpaid volunteer in Year 1 — 100% of donations reach veterans directly.

THE ASK

Help Us Launch.

YEAR 1 FUNDING NEED

\$65,000

to fund 3 pilot retreats and serve 15-18 combat veterans

Founder serves unpaid — 100% of donations reach veterans

A single retreat costs roughly **\$13,000**.

A full pilot year costs **\$65,000**.

The cost of one veteran lost to suicide is incalculable.

USE OF FUNDS

Where Your Dollars Go.

Direct Retreat Costs (lodging, food, activities, travel for vets) **34%**

Founder/ED Stipend (program management) **23%**

Insurance & Legal (operating safely & legally) **7%**

Operations (admin, software, communications) **6%**

Marketing & Outreach (reach more veterans) **4%**

Setup & Compliance (501c3 filing, accounting setup) **3%**

Reserves & Contingency **23%**

More than 60% of every dollar goes directly to veterans served.

GET INVOLVED

Turn the Tide With Us.

Whether you can give, partner, volunteer, or just spread the word — every veteran we reach matters.

JOHN COLLINS

FOUNDER, TURNING THE TIDES

 (615) 739-3008

 spc2233@hotmail.com

A 501(c)(3) Nonprofit Organization | Maui, Hawaii